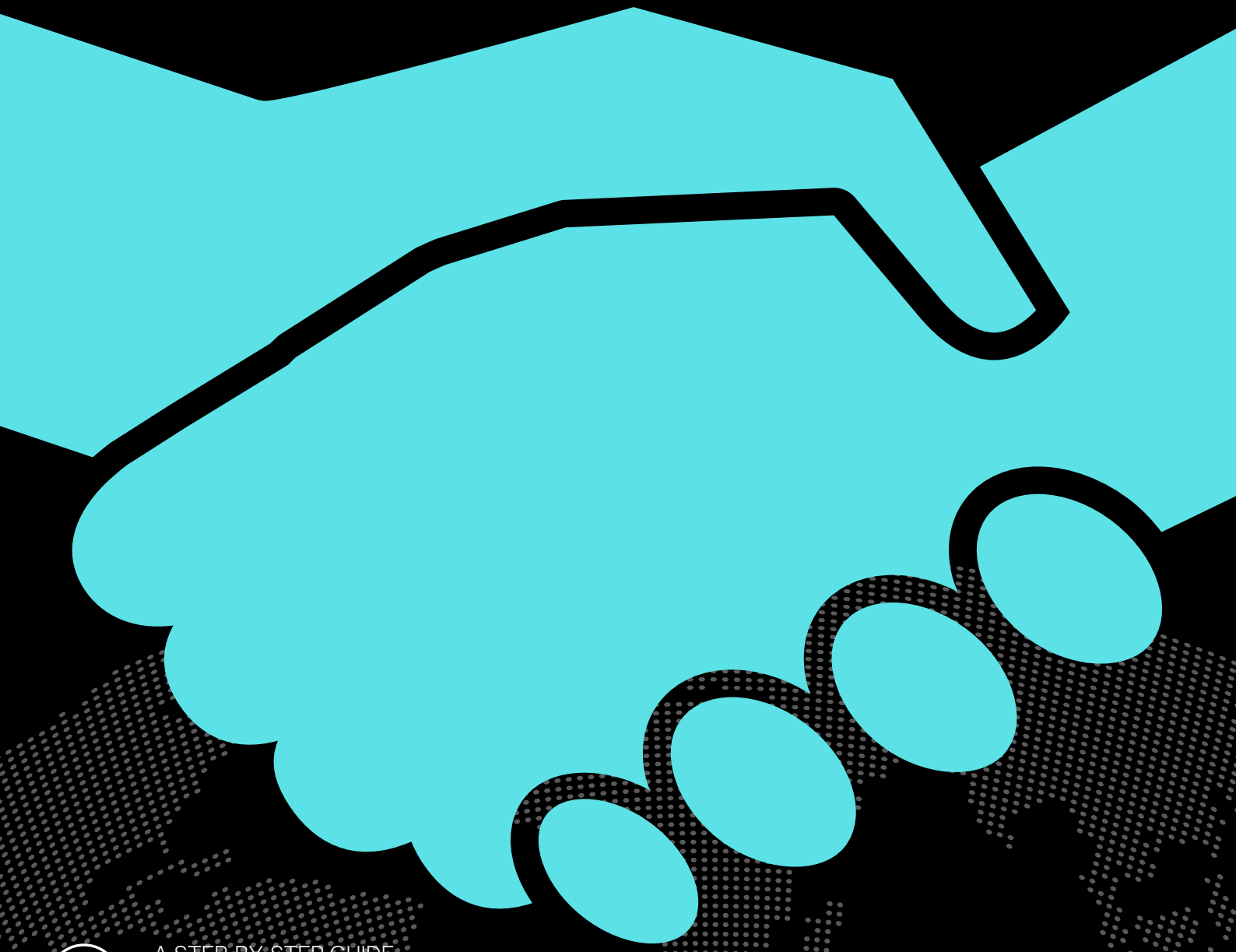
Digital Learning

Turn Your Business's Inquiries into Cash

(How to stop losing clients in your DMs)



A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE
Navigate your way through knowing what to do and approaches to go about making sure you retain your Clients

by Ebuka Chidube

The Author

HELLO THERE! I'M EBUKA.

A digital marketing professional with experience spanning over 20 brands. With a background in social media management and 2 time big brother housemate social media handler, he transitioned into tech in 2022. Since then he has gone ahead to lead marketing at big companies like Lenco, i-Fitness, Altschool, With Chude, an Al startup in Australia and many others. He currently drives digital marketing at Piggyvest and also the founder and CEO of The Exodigital. An agency, helping medium scale businesses improve their marketing.

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CHAPTER N.1

E-commerce Owner's **Guide to Converting DMs To Sales**

"Running an e-commerce business in Nigeria comes with its unique challenges."

E-commerce Owner's Guide to Converting DMs To Sales ✳

Running an e-commerce business in Nigeria comes with its unique challenges. You're posting your products regularly on social media and whatsapp, getting lots of "How much?" comments and DMs, but most people disappear after asking about the price. Some even say "I'll pay on Friday" and never show up.

If this sounds familiar, you're not alone.
As an e-commerce business owner in Nigeria, you're dealing with:

- **Time wasters who just want to "check price"**
- **People who ghost after price disclosure**
- **Payment delays and excuses**
- **Trust issues from potential customers**
- **Competition from bigger platforms**

This guide will show you exactly how to turn those "How much?" inquiries into actual sales, using proven methods that work specifically in the Nigerian market.

The SELLS Framework for E-commerce ✳

Step 1: Capture Their Pain Points

The biggest mistake Nigerian e-commerce owners make is revealing prices too early or in the wrong way.

HERE'S HOW TO DO IT:

The Perfect Price Reveal Formula:

When someone asks **"How much?"**, respond with:
"Hello! Thank you for your interest in [product]. To give you the best price, please let me know:

Would you prefer delivery or pickup?
Which area are you located?
When would you need it?"

After they respond, say:
"Perfect! We have [product] available at ₦[price]. This includes:
[Feature/benefit 1]
[Feature/benefit 2]
[Feature/benefit 3]
Delivery to [their location] is ₦[amount].

We also have a special discount for first-time buyers!"

WHY THIS WORKS:

- **Creates engagement before price reveal**
- **Shows professionalism**
- **Positions you as a proper business**
- **Gives room for upselling**
- **Addresses delivery concerns upfront**

ACTION EXERCISE:

Create these message templates in your notes app and use them for your next 10 inquiries.

Step 2: Establish Trust Quickly

Nigerian buyers need to trust you before they pay. Here's how to build instant credibility:

THE TRUST-BUILDING SYSTEM:

- **Product Presentation**
- **Clear, well-lit photos from multiple angles**
- **Video showcasing the product**
- **Close-up shots of important details**
- **Size comparison photos**
- **Photos of the product in use**

Have all of these on your social media pages. Trust me they will check.

SOCIAL PROOF DISPLAY

- **Screenshots of customer reviews**
- **Photos of customers with their orders**
- **Unboxing videos from customers**
- **Payment confirmation screenshots (blur sensitive details)**

PROFESSIONAL PAGES

- **Business WhatsApp account**
- **Professional bio on social media**
- **Highlight saved stories of deliveries**
- **Customer feedback highlights**

SAMPLE WHATSAPP BUSINESS BIO:

- 🏆 [X] Happy Customers
- ✅ Authentic Products
- 🚚 Nationwide Delivery if you do so or the locations where you deliver
- 🏦 Bank/Transfer Payment
- 📍 Based in (Location)
- ⭐ Since (Year)

Step 3: Lead with Limited Time Offers

Create urgency without being pushy:

EFFECTIVE OFFER STRUCTURES:

- Time-Limited Deals

"Special Price Valid Till (specific time/date)"

- Quantity-Limited Offers

"Only 3 pieces remaining at this price"

- Bonus-Driven Offers

"Next 5 buyers get (free bonus item)"

SAMPLE MESSAGE TEMPLATE:

- Current Price: ₦X
- Regular Price: ₦Y
- You save: ₦Z
- ⚡ Flash Sale Ends: [Time/Date]
- 🎁 Bonus: [Special Add-on]
- ✅ Available: [Number] pieces left

TO SECURE YOURS: TIME TO GET THE MONEY

- **Send [amount] to:**
- **Bank Details**
- **Send payment proof here**
- **Receive tracking details within 1 hour**

Step 4: Lock In with Easy Payment Options

Make it super easy to pay:

PAYMENT STRUCTURE OPTIONS:

This will push them to take action.

- **5% discount for immediate payment**
- **Same-day shipping for orders before 2PM**
- **Free delivery for orders above ₦XX,XXX**

RESERVATION SYSTEM

If you have a warehouse with the actual product, you can use this system

- **30% deposit to secure item**
- **Balance on delivery**
- **Valid for 24 hours only**

GROUP BUY DISCOUNTS

- **Special rates for 3+ items**
- **Shared delivery costs for location-based sales (If you pay now, you get xyz delivery discounts because of shared delivery)**
- **Bulk order benefits**

HANDLING PAYMENT OBJECTIONS:

When they say: "Can you reduce?"
Respond: "Our prices are already competitive, but I can offer you [smaller quantity/different variant] at ₦[lower price point] or include [bonus item] at the current price. Which would you prefer?"

When they say: "Can I pay on delivery?"
Respond: "For your security and mine, we use a reservation system. Pay 30% (₦X) to secure your item and the balance on delivery. This guarantees you get exactly what you ordered. Shall I send the account details?"

Step 5: Secure Return Customers

Nigerian buyers need to trust you before they pay. Here's how to build instant credibility:

AFTER-SALE SYSTEM:

- **Immediate Follow-up**
- **Send tracking details promptly**
- **Provide delivery timeline**
- **Share product care instructions**

GROUP BUY DISCOUNTS

- Special rates for 3+ items
- Shared delivery costs
- Bulk order benefits

DELIVERY DAY

- Send preparation message
- Confirm delivery
- Request feedback

RETURN CUSTOMER BENEFITS

- Create VIP customer list
- Early access to new products
- Special discounts for referrals

SAMPLE FOLLOW-UP MESSAGE:

"Hello [Name]! Your [product] has been delivered. 🎉
Please check that everything is perfect!
As a valued customer, you now have:
✨ Early access to new arrivals
🎁 10% off your next purchase
👥 5% discount for every referral
Save my number: (Your business number)
Follow us: (Social media handles)
Thank you for choosing (Your Business Name) 🙏"

CHAPTER N.2

Service Business Owner's Guide to **Converting Inquiries into Loyal Customers**

"Shows organization and professionalism"

Service Business Owner's Guide to Converting Inquiries into Loyal Customers

As a service business owner in Nigeria - whether you're running a salon, dry cleaning service, logistics, interior decoration business, or any other local service - you know the frustration:

- **People book appointments and don't show up**
- **Customers constantly haggle for lower prices**
- **Prospects disappear after price quotations**
- **Clients delay payments after service**
- **Competition from cheaper, less professional providers**

If you're dealing with these challenges, this guide will show you exactly how to turn price inquiries into paying customers, and one-time clients into loyal patrons.

The SERVE Framework for Service Businesses

Step 1: Set Professional Standards

The key to charging premium prices is showing premium value from the first interaction.

Professional Response System:

FIRST CONTACT TEMPLATE:

"Welcome to (Business Name)! 👋

Thank you for your interest in our (service type).
Our working hours are (times).

To serve you better, please let me know:
Which service are you interested in?
When would you like to book?
Have you used our services before?
(Your Name)
(Business Name)"

PRICE INQUIRY RESPONSE:

"Thank you for asking about our (service). Our prices start from ₦(X) depending on [variables]. These variables depend on the customer's needs

Would you like me to:
A) Share our full price list
B) Book you for a specific service
C) Explain more about what's included
Many of our clients choose option C to ensure they get exactly what they need."

WHY THIS WORKS:

- **Shows organization and professionalism**
- **Builds value before discussing price**
- **Gives options to continue conversation**
- **Sets you apart from casual providers**

Step 2: Explain Value Clearly

Don't just list prices - show why you're worth it.

VALUE PRESENTATION FORMULA:

Some examples

For Hair Stylists:

Our [hairstyle] service at ₦[X] includes:

- **Free consultation**
- **Premium products used**
- **Style longevity guarantee**
- **Free touch-up within 48 hours**
- **Hygiene-first approach**

For Dry Cleaners:

Our premium dry cleaning service includes:

- **Stain pre-treatment**
- **Quality checking**
- **Minor repairs included**
- **Proper packaging**
- **SMS updates**

For Interior Decorators:

Our consultation package includes:

- **Space assessment**
- **Mood board creation**
- **Material suggestions**
- **Budget planning**

Step 3: Run a Booking System

Reduce no-shows and time wasters with a proper booking system.
Booking Confirmation Process:

INITIAL BOOKING MESSAGE:

"Thank you for choosing to book with us!

Your requested appointment:
Date: (Date)
Time: (Time)
Service: (Service)
Estimated Cost: ₦(Amount)
To confirm your booking:

Please send a deposit of ₦(Amount)
Account details: (Bank info)
Share proof of payment

Once confirmed, you'll receive our address and prep instructions."

BOOKING REMINDER SYSTEM:

24 Hours Before:

"Hello! Reminder of your appointment tomorrow at [time]. Please reply 'Confirm' to keep your slot, or reschedule 24hrs before to avoid losing your deposit."

3 Hours Before:

"Your appointment is in 3 hours. We're getting ready for you! Need our location? Reply 'Yes'

HANDLING BOOKING OBJECTIONS:

When they say: "I can't pay deposit"
Respond: "I understand. However, our deposit system helps us prepare specifically for you and ensures you get priority service. The deposit is deducted from your final bill. Would you like to reschedule for when you can secure your slot?"
When they say: "That's too expensive"
Respond: "I understand you're looking for the best value. Let me explain what makes our service different:

(Unique benefit 1)
(Unique benefit 2)
(Unique benefit 3)

Would you like to try our [alternative service] first to experience our quality?"

Step 4: Validate Through Proof

Show evidence of your quality work. Post enough on your page. They will check before making any payments.
Social Proof System:

BEFORE/AFTER CONTENT

- **Clear, well-lit photos**
- **Same angle comparisons**
- **Video testimonials**
- **Process videos**

CLIENT SHOWCASE

- **Fresh styles/work daily**
- **Tag happy customers**
- **Share reviews**
- **Show busy days**

BEHIND THE SCENES

- Tools/products used
- Team training
- Quality processes
- Workspace tours

SAMPLE CUSTOMER REVIEW REQUEST:

"Thank you for choosing (Business Name)!
Would you mind helping other customers
by sharing:

What you liked about our service
A photo of your [result]
Any suggestions for improvement

As a thank you, you'll get (discount/offer)
on your next visit! "

Step 5: Establish Retention Systems

Turn one-time customers into regulars.
Client Retention Strategy:

SERVICE FOLLOW-UP (24 HOURS AFTER):

"Hello [Name]! How are you enjoying your (service)?

Here are some tips to maintain your (result):
(3 quick tips)
Book your next appointment within 7 days and get (special offer)!"

LOYALTY PROGRAM:

"Congratulations! You're now a VIP client!

- Your benefits:
- Priority booking
- 10% off every 3rd visit
- Birthday special treat
- Early access to promos
- Referral rewards
- Save our number: (Business number)"

REGULAR CHECK-INS:

"Hello [Name]! It's been [timeframe] since your last [service].

We have some new [services/offers] you might love:
[List 2-3 relevant services]
Would you like to book your next appointment?"

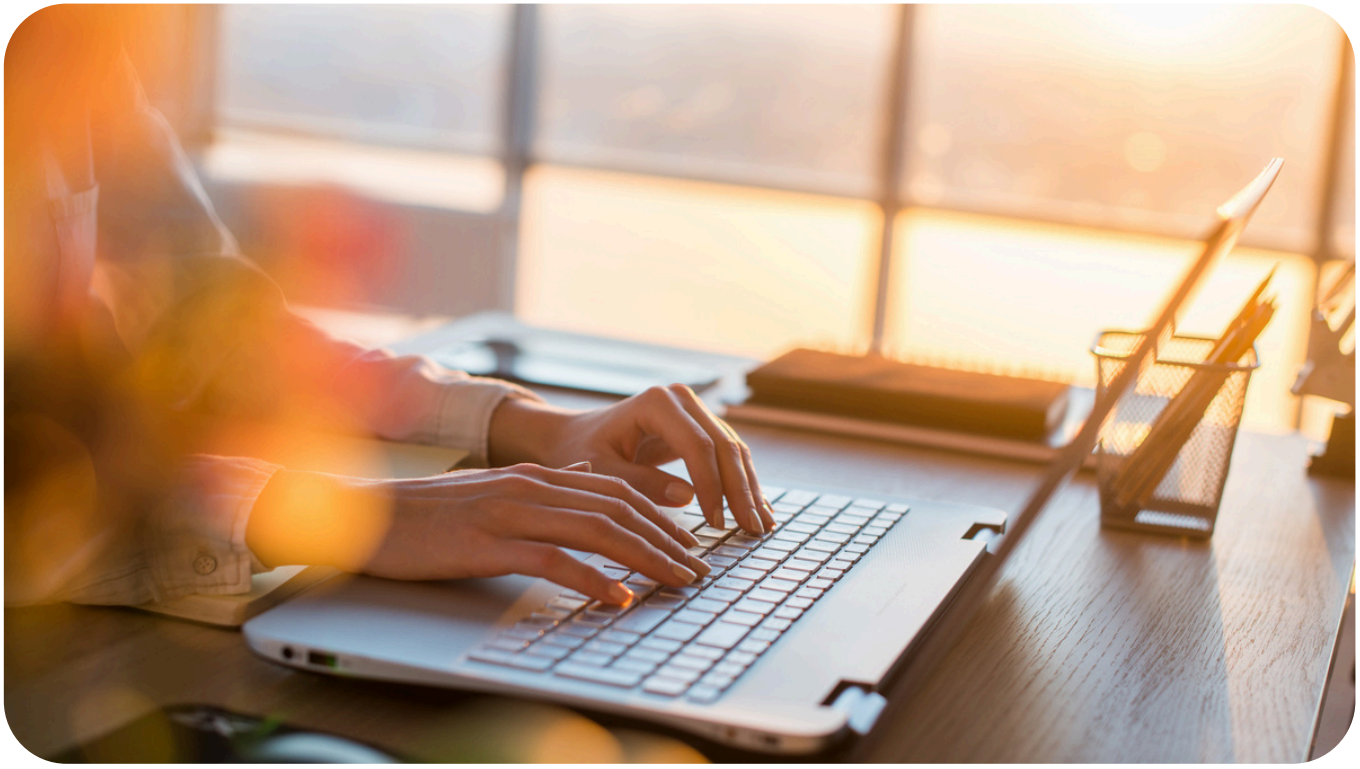
CHAPTER N.3

Freelancer's Guide to Converting Inquiries into **High-Paying Clients**

"Running an e-commerce business in Nigeria comes with its unique challenges."

Freelancer's Guide to Converting Inquiries into High-Paying Clients

As a Nigerian freelancer - whether you're a social media manager, graphic designer, content creator, or digital service provider - these scenarios probably sound familiar:



- **Clients expecting foreign-level quality at "local" prices**
- **People ghosting after your quotation**
- **Clients demanding unlimited revisions**
- **Payment delays and excuses**
- **Prospects who "want to see samples" but never convert**
- **Competition from cheaper freelancers**

This guide will show you exactly how to turn price inquiries into high-paying clients, and one-off projects into long-term retainers.

The PRICE Framework for Freelancers ✳

Step 1: Position Your Service Professionally

Stop competing on price by positioning yourself as a professional consultant.
Professional Inquiry System:

FIRST RESPONSE TEMPLATE:

"Hello [Name],

Thank you for your interest in my [service] services. I help businesses [core benefit - e.g., "increase their social media engagement" or "stand out with professional designs"].
To provide an accurate quote, please share:

Your business type/industry
Current challenges you're facing
Goals for this project
Timeline requirements

I'll reply with relevant examples and solutions within 2 hours.
Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Title]"

PORTFOLIO PRESENTATION:

"Based on your needs, here are some relevant projects:

{Project 1 Name]
(Specific metric)
(Specific metric)
(Client testimonial)

(Project 2 Name)
Results achieved:
(Specific metric)
(Specific metric)
(Client testimonial)

Would you like to discuss how we can achieve similar results for your business?

Step 2: Rate Structure Mastery

Price your services to reflect your value.
Pricing Templates: Here are some examples, Feel free to tweak
For Social Media Managers:

SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT PACKAGES:

🔸 **Starter: ₦(X)/month**

- **(Number) posts per week**
- **Basic engagement**
- **Monthly report**
- **2 revisions per post**

🔹 **Professional: ₦(Y)/month**

- **(Number) posts per week**
- **Story updates**
- **Community management**
- **Analytics report**
- **3 revisions per post**

💎 **Premium: ₦(Z)/month**

- **All Professional features**
- **Content strategy**
- **Influencer outreach**
- **Crisis management**
- **Unlimited revisions**

FOR GRAPHIC DESIGNERS:

🔸 **Single Design: ₦(X)**

- **2 concepts**
- **3 revisions**
- **Source file**
- **48hr delivery**

🔹 **Design Package: ₦(Y)**

- **5 related designs**
- **3 concepts each**
- **3 revisions each**
- **Source files**
- **5-day delivery**

💎 **Retainer: ₦(Z)/month**

- **Up to 10 designs**
- **Priority service**
- **Unlimited revisions**
- **Brand consistency**
- **24hr delivery**

Step 3: Initial Consultation Conversion

Turn consultation calls into projects.
Consultation Framework:

PRE-CALL MESSAGE:

""Looking forward to our call tomorrow at [time].

To make our discussion productive, please:

Have your current [materials/accounts] ready
Prepare any specific questions
Think about your ideal timeline

I'll share my screen to show relevant examples and walk you through potential solutions."

CALL STRUCTURE:

5 mins: Introduction and goal setting
10 mins: Client situation analysis
15 mins: Solution presentation
15 mins: Questions and next steps
5 mins: Proposal and timeline discussion

POST-CALL FOLLOW-UP:

"Thank you for our productive discussion about [their project].

As discussed, here's what we can achieve together:

[Goal 1]
[Goal 2]
[Goal 3]

Investment: ₦[Amount]
Timeline: [Duration]
To proceed:
50% deposit to secure spot
Send brand materials
Start by [date]

Shall I send the payment details?"

Step 4: Contract and Payment Security

Protect yourself and show professionalism.
Project Protection System:

CONTRACT ESSENTIALS:

- **Scope of work**
- **Number of revisions**
- **Timeline**
- **Payment terms**
- **Additional fees**
- **Cancellation policy**

PAYMENT STRUCTURE:

Project Payment Schedule:

- **50% deposit to begin**
- **25% at first draft**
- **25% before final files**

PAYMENT METHODS:

Bank transfer
(Other payment options)

Note: Work begins after deposit confirmation

REVISION MANAGEMENT:

Revision Policy:
✓ **(Number) rounds included**
✓ **48-hour revision window**
✓ **Additional revisions: ₦(X) each**
✓ **Rush fee: +50% of base price**

Step 5: Exceed and Extend

Turn one-off projects into long-term relationships.
Client Retention Strategy:

PROJECT UPDATES:

Project Milestone Update:

- **Task completed**
- **Task in progress**
- **Next milestone**
- **Additional value added**

Need any adjustments before we proceed?

PROJECT COMPLETION:

"Thank you for trusting me with your project!

To ensure continued success:

- **Maintenance tip**
- **Usage guidance**
- **Future recommendation**

Book your next project within 14 days for 20% off!"

RETAINER CONVERSION:

"Congratulations on completing your project!

To maintain momentum, consider our retainer package:

- **Priority service**
- **Better rates**
- **Regular updates**
- **Strategic planning**
- **[Other benefits]**

Special offer: Lock in current rates for 3 months!"

FINAL NOTES

As you can see from this ebook, these strategies emphasize the need not to rush to put prices in front of potential customers.

People buy from people, not brands, the more human you sound and feel, the more people can trust you with their money.

If you do all of these and still do not close that customer, do not feel bad at all, not every inquiry is going to be a sale, but with these tips and templates I shared in this book, if you are able to implement them, you improve your chances to make that sale.

This guide works for all types of businesses. What you need is to take them and tweak them as needed.

I wish you the absolute best in your business endeavours.

Want more insights like this?

Ready to Scale **Your Business Further?**

While this framework will help you convert more leads, having expert support can accelerate your results.

WHAT WE OFFER

1. **Done-for-You Marketing Services**
2. **Sales Closing Support**
3. **Personal Mentorship**

CONTACT

To explore how we can help grow your business:
Email: chidubeebuka525@gmail.com
Phone: 08052998960